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Rose

That night, Rose rushed to bring the report to Reinhardt. In the office at the sick bay, she'd waited for Josef to finish dictating the last pages to Léa. Every time Léa pressed the typewriter's carriage return lever, a loud *thunk* reverberated in the room, reminding Rose of the sound of the clock in Reinhardt's office, and his penchant for punctuality.

The longer she waited, the more the unease that had been gnawing at the back of her mind grew. For the last weeks, she'd felt a change in Reinhardt, not so much what he said, but how. His rants had taken on a sharper tone as he railed against the Boshelvik forces of chaos and unreason. *The greatest virtue isn't goodness but courage*, he'd said, slamming his fist on the desk. She no longer had the sense that he was speaking to her, or even enjoyed her company. She wasn't sure why he kept insisting that she deliver the reports to his office. Léa said his behavior was likely due to the uncertainty and stress brought about by Germany's retreating position in the war. Everyone could see they were losing, and it was only a matter of time with the non-stop Allied bombings of all major cities until the country collapsed. Whatever the reason, Rose had grown weary of the Gestapo officer, and she feared that being late tonight could upset him.

"Good evening, Herr Reinhardt," she said, slightly out of breath, having climbed the stairs two at a time. "Please excuse my tardiness."

He looked up from the desk, a cold glint in his eyes. "A busy day at the sick bay?"

"Yes." She put the report on his desk and took a seat. She didn't think he would keep her long; she would need to return to the barracks before